

Ags Hand Miners Cut In Confidence

New Mexico State was certainly not what the doctor prescribed for building the University of Texas at El Paso's confidence for upcoming Western Athletic Conference play.

The Aggies not only stopped the Miners Tuesday in a doubleheader 9-1 and 6-5 at Dudley Field but left UTEP wondering where its hitting and fielding went suddenly.

NMSU's Kevin Stegar hurled a five-hitter in the opener, retiring 10 Miners in a row before UTEP's Art Bravo singled to lead off the sixth and eventually scored on Bob Alsup's single to right.

By then, though, it was too late as the Aggies had scored all nine of their runs in handing UTEP its worse defeat of the season.

"Every ball we tagged, they made a good defensive job of getting to the ball," said Miner coach Andy Cohen. "Stegar had good velocity on his pitches."

NMSU's bats began to key off on previously undefeated Wes Zoltz in the first inning when John Clark, one of the top hitters in the nation with a .460 average, homered over the left-center field fence after Elliott Chapman had walked with two outs.

Four Aggie singles and a hit batter produced three runs in the fourth and New Mexico State added four more in the sixth, two of which were unearned.

Bravo was the only UTEP batter to get past second base the entire game.

Five errors in the nightcap proved

UTEP's downfall but the Miners almost pulled the game out in the late stages when Jim Bradford unloaded a three-run homer over the wall in left in the sixth which cut NMSU's lead to 6-5.

The Miners couldn't score the final run they needed in the seventh although Alsup tied a school record with his 12th stolen base of the season to advance to second with two outs after singling to right.

Former Burges hurler Randy Larson, who spent his first two years of college ball at Ranger Junior College, missed going the distance after allowing Alsup his seventh inning single.

"I let one pitch get away," said the southpaw, referring to Bradford's third homer of the season. "My arm has been bothering me lately and it looks like I'll have to have an operation this summer."

The double loss gives UTEP a 21-10 record heading into Friday's WAC opener against Arizona State at Dudley Field. NMSU is now 14-15 for the year, winning 10 of its last 14 games.— **Mark Leibson**

First Game NMSU 9, UTEP 1

NMSU	200	304	0-9	14	1
UTEP	000	001	0-1	5	1

Second Game NMSU 6, UTEP 5

NMSU	112	110	0-6	9	1
UTEP	100	004	0-5	8	5

Randy Larson, Danny Quinn (7) and Phil Rector, Jerry Walker, K.C. Nix (4), Jim Sacco (7) and Sal Flores, W. Larson (23), L. Walker (31). HR, UTEP Jim Bradford (3).